

Tarun Poddar, A story of “Never Give Up” starting from a Street Vendor to owning India’s finest Venture Capital.



Tarun Poddar
CEO
Foxhog

Tarun Poddar, the visionary CEO of Foxhog, emerging as a remarkable example of visionary leadership in India’s evolving venture capital industry and becoming a key player in shaping the future of the nation’s entrepreneurial ecosystem. Born on March 16, 1994, in Delhi, Tarun’s rise from a lower-middle-class background to the helm of a prominent venture capital firm is nothing short of inspiring, and serves as a testament to his ambition, perseverance, and innovation.

In an industry often dominated by the affluent and the well-connected, Tarun’s rise is particularly noteworthy. Recognizing the vast untapped potential beyond India’s metropolitan centers, his focus on rural India marks a paradigm shift in how venture capital can reach and uplift underserved regions. Under his leadership, Foxhog Ventures has become a driving force in bridging the gap between rural entrepreneurs and the resources they need to thrive.

To bring his vision to life, Tarun

introduced the innovative initiative “VC for Village.” He explains, “We identified a significant gap in rural India—small businesses lacked access to the necessary funding to get started. A company operating out of a modest 1BHK in a tier-3 city often cannot afford the high costs associated with services like valuations, auditing or compliance from tier 1 firm. Consequently, these businesses were left with few options, often resorting to traditional methods of financing.

We saw untapped potential in these companies, with the ability to turn the founders’ vision into reality.” Today, Foxhog Ventures has expanded its reach, with a presence in over 4500 villages, supporting countless farmers and small entrepreneurs in realizing their aspirations and driving the growth of their businesses.

Growing up in Delhi heading to be in the list of one of the youngest self made billionaire, Tarun faced the challenges common to a lower-middle-class family. Despite limited resources, his relentless determination to succeed was evident from an early age. His hard work and academic achievements led him to Stanford University, where he laid the groundwork for his future career. After graduating, Tarun began his professional journey, first as the Operations Head at the esteemed Boeing aviation company, followed by a role as Process Head at iTunes. It was through these experiences that the entrepreneurial spark within him ignited. Driven by a vision to create something of his own, Tarun founded Today, Foxhog stands as a testament to his success, with an annual turnover of over \$250 million and a team of over 3000 plus employees spread across 6 countries, continuing to make strides in the venture capital space.

This remarkable journey has earned Mr. Poddar numerous accolades, including being a TEDx Speaker and receiving

the prestigious Forbes “30 Under 30” recognition. In addition, Foxhog Ventures was honored with the “Emerging VC and Investment Bank of the Year 2024” award, is a testament to the firm’s significant influence and contribution to the startup ecosystem. These achievements highlight the profound impact that Tarun and his Company have made in reshaping the future of venture capital.

Foxhog Ventures has also been recognized as “Employer of the Year,” due to their marvelous employee policy and one of the interesting feature called “SALARY BEFORE 15 DAY” a distinction that highlights the company’s commitment to fostering an environment where employees can thrive both professionally and personally. The firm has made it a priority to ensure that its team members are able to achieve a healthy work-life balance while working at their full potential. One such initiative, the “workation” policy, has gained attention for allowing employees to work remotely from scenic locations, including the mountains, while maintaining their productivity. This innovative approach showcases the company’s dedication to creating a positive and healthy work atmosphere, proving that a harmonious balance between work and personal life is not only achievable but also enhances performance and well-being.

Investment in over more than 57 companies, Foxhog has been one of the finest VC in the country. Looking ahead, Tarun remains steadfast in his mission to democratize access to capital for entrepreneurs across India. He envisions a landscape where startups from rural and urban areas have equal opportunities to thrive. Through Foxhog Ventures and his various initiatives, he continues to champion innovation, inclusivity, and sustainable growth, aiming to leave a lasting impact on India’s economic and social fabric.